

August 18, 2026

Upstart Hiring Team,

My name is Nic Mansfield, and I'm reaching out to submit my application for the **Senior Engineering Manager, Site Reliability** position at Upstart.

I've spent the last 20 years leading enterprise infrastructure, technology operations, and multi-site platform availability across Utah. During my career, I've *specialized* in transforming complex, high-scale systems into reliable, observable, and disciplined engineering engines.

Most recently, I governed major technology evolutions, cloud migrations, and site reliability operations across large-scale enterprise environments – including Blue Coat Systems, Symantec, and Broadcom. These roles gave me the hands-on leadership experience to build resilient operating models, strong incident policy, and cohesive, high-performing technical teams.

I spent time reviewing the charter for Upstart's SRE organization, and I see immediate alignment with how I lead:

- **SRE Strategy & Operational Maturity:** I focus on treating *reliability as a core product feature*. I have direct experience defining functional charters, managing capacity-aware roadmaps, and establishing operational readiness standards so software engineering teams can deploy and operate safely at scale.
- **Incident Leadership & Blameless RCA:** Throughout my career, I've regularly acted as the 'Incident Commander' for high-severity platform outages. I prioritize standardizing escalation paths, running disciplined yet *blameless* postmortems (Black Box Thinking), and ensuring post-incident learnings translate into automated safeguards and durable engineering fixes.
- **Observability & Toil Reduction:** I have a background standardizing telemetry across metrics, logs, and traces (OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Datadog) while embedding SLOs and error budgets into product roadmaps. I focus heavily on eliminating noisy alerts, closing detection gaps, and automating repetitive operational toil.
- **People Leadership & Cross-Functional Influence:** For nearly 15 years I have been a dedicated mentor and team builder focused on scaling 24/7 technical operations, building clear ownership models, and translating complex reliability data into actionable executive insights.

I would love the chance to bring my background, pragmatic approach, and team leadership to Upstart's remote SRE team.

I really appreciate the consideration and hope to speak with your team soon!

Nic Mansfield
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